Senior Data Engineer – Technical Interview Brief

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Your technical interview is a working session, not a quiz. You'll work through data problems like the ones you'd own here, together with two members of the team.

What to expect

There are no trick questions and no live coding test. We want to see how you think through problems you would actually own here. That means how you ask questions, weigh tradeoffs and explain your reasoning.

Think of us as your future teammates. Ask us anything you'd ask on day one: how the data flows, who uses it, what has broken before. We'll answer, clarify and sometimes push back. It's fine to say "I don't know, here's how I'd find out." It's also fine to change your mind halfway through.

How the session runs

1. **Architecture walkthrough.** We'll show you a diagram of our current data platform and talk it through. It's built on the stack named in the job description: Snowflake, Stitch and Metabase. Ask as many questions as you like here.
2. **Collaborative problem solving.** We'll work through a handful of scenarios built on that architecture. Each one is a conversation. We'll add detail as you ask for it.
3. **Your questions.** Time at the end for anything you want to know about the role, the team or Minga.

A whiteboard or shared screen is available if you like to sketch. You're welcome to use AI tools the way you would at work. Just talk us through how you check what they give you.

The five themes

The scenarios fall into five themes. The questions below are examples in the same spirit, not the exact ones we'll ask.

Theme	Example questions
1. Bringing engineering practice to analyst work	You want to introduce a standard nobody asked for. How would you get people on board?
2. Data incidents and data quality	Something you own breaks in production. How would you let people know, and what would you change afterwards?
3. Migrating to a new data model	You need to run two versions of a system side by side for a long time. What would you watch out for?
4. Access control and sensitive data	AI assistants can query your company's data. What guardrails would you put in place?
5. Cost and value	How would you decide whether a tool or service is worth what it costs?

What we look for

We care more about how you think than about a perfect answer. The job description is a good guide to what matters in this role.

How to prepare

- Reread the job description. Each theme maps to something you'd own.
- No need to study our product or memorise tool trivia. We'll give you the context in the room.